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PLACEMENT CONTACT

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Public Finance, Corporate Taxation, Development Economics

REFERENCES

Mazhar Waseem
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James Banks
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Rachel Griffith
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Anne Brockmeyer
World Bank
abrockmeyer@worldbank.org

Pierce O'Reilly
OECD
pierce.oreilly@oecd.org

EDUCATION

PhD Economics, The University of Manchester, UK — 2027 (expected)
PhD Intern, Centre for Tax Policy and Administration, OECD — 2025
PhD Enrichment Scholar, TaxDev, Institute for Fiscal Studies — 2024
MSc Economics (with Distinction), University of Sussex, UK — 2018
BSc Economics, Universidad de Costa Rica, Costa Rica — 2014

JOB MARKET PAPER

Less Simple, Less Distortionary? Evidence from Costa Rica's Corporate Tax Reform

with Jonathan Garita

Simple but distortionary tax designs are widely used in the taxation of firms in developing economies. This paper examines whether less simple designs, which can reduce these distortions, introduce new ones as firms face less simple tax incentives. Using quasi-experimental variation in tax rates introduced by Costa Rica's 2020 Corporate Income Tax reform, which replaced a simple but highly distortionary notched schedule with a less simple kinked one, we show that firms react to the right incentives by adjusting their reported profits to changes in marginal tax rates, and not to changes in average tax rates, thus without the average-rate biases documented for individuals. Responses to tax cuts and increases are also symmetric, with elasticities of reported profits of about 3.1–3.2, suggesting that the concern raised for other taxes, that reversing a tax change may not undo its effects, may be smaller for corporate taxes. Bunching below the removed notch and cost inflation above it also disappeared, and little or no bunching emerged at the new profit thresholds. We argue that less simple tax designs can reduce distortions without firms misreading their incentives, and should hence be considered in developing countries as a more economically efficient alternative.

WORKING PAPERS

Multinational Responses to Coordinated Tax Reform: Evidence from the Global Minimum Tax

with Felix Hugger and Tom Zawisza | OECD Taxation Working Paper No. 77 | Submitted

We study how multinational enterprises (MNEs) respond to an internationally coordinated change in corporate taxation. The introduction of the Global Minimum Tax (GMT) in 2024 subjected MNEs with revenues above EUR 750m to a minimum effective rate of 15%. We exploit this revenue threshold in a difference-in-differences framework to assess the impact of the GMT on effective tax rates, investment and employment. Using group-level Orbis data, we find that previously low-taxed MNEs increased effective tax rates by around 1.7 percentage points, and increased global corporate tax revenues by 2.4-3.4%. However, this increase was not accompanied by a detectable reduction in investment or employment. The increase in effective tax rates is concentrated in MNEs more likely to have greater profit shifting opportunities and higher profitability. The findings provide first ex-post evidence on the effects of the GMT and suggest that internationally coordinated reforms can raise the effective taxation of MNEs without generating short-run reductions in economic activity.

Low-Earning Workers and Social Security: Evidence from Costa Rica's Contributions Reform

with Laura Abramovsky and Jonathan Garita

Social security contributions raise the cost of formal employment and are considered a key determinant of informality among low-wage workers in developing economies, yet evidence on whether reducing them increases registration is mixed. In Costa Rica, a minimum contribution floor makes registration particularly costly for these workers and their employers. In 2023, a reform lowered this floor, reducing contributions for both employers and employees, with a gradual rollout by age. Using administrative and survey data and a regression discontinuity design that exploits the phased implementation, we evaluate the reform's effects on registration and other labour market outcomes six months after it came into force. We find no significant effects on registration or on earnings reported to the social security administration. However, using constructed measures of net and gross earnings, we find higher take-home pay for workers and lower total labour costs for firms, with cost savings shared in line with the statutory changes. These short-term results suggest that lowering contribution costs alone may not be enough to increase registration, and that complementary policies are needed to address remaining barriers to formality.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2026	Oxford Centre for Business Taxation Doctoral Conference; Mannheim Taxation Conference; The University of Manchester; Institute for Fiscal Studies
2025	ZEW Public Finance Conference; Royal Economic Society Conference; International Institute of Public Finance Conference; OECD Tax Policy and Statistics Division Lunch Seminar; OECD Working Party 2 on Tax Policy Analysis and Tax Statistics
2024	Royal Economic Society PhD Conference; The Economics of Informality Conference (Universidad de los Andes); Programa Estado de la Nación; Universidad de Costa Rica; Institute for Fiscal Studies
2023	Economists Conference of Costa Rica; North West Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership Conference
2015–2021	Commission of Coastal and Border Zones, Costa Rican Congress (2021); Western Economic Association International Conference (2021); Annual Meeting of the Environment for Development Initiative (2020); Costa Rican Presidential National Council for Children (2019); Annual Meeting of the CASCADE Project (2015)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Associate, Department of Economics, The University of Manchester — 2025–present
Economics for Public Policy (TA Lead), Microeconomics 2 (TA Lead), Microeconomics 1, Microeconomics 3, Advanced Statistics, Applied Economics

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, The University of Manchester — 2022–2025
Economics for Public Policy, Microeconomics 2

Lecturer, School of Economics, Universidad de Costa Rica — 2017, 2019–2021
Introduction to Economics (2017), Research Methods (Postgraduate, 2019–2021)

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Sussex — 2018–2019
Economic Principles

Teaching Assistant, School of Economics, Universidad de Costa Rica — 2012
Introduction to Economics

RESEARCH AND POLICY EXPERIENCE

Researcher, International Growth Centre, London School of Economics 2025–present
Researcher, Economic Sciences Research Institute (IICE), Universidad de Costa Rica 2019–2021
Researcher, Tropical Agricultural Research and Higher Education Center 2019–2021
Junior Researcher, Development Observatory (OdD), Universidad de Costa Rica 2016–2017
Research Assistant, Tropical Agricultural Research and Higher Education Center 2014–2016

SELECTED POLICY WORK

Import Tax Evasion, Drivers and Recommendations for Tanzania
International Growth Centre, London School of Economics, 2026

Dynamics and Impacts of the 2019 Tax Reform on the Costa Rican Labour Market
with Juan Robalino, Andrés Fiallos and Felipe Carrera / Universidad de Costa Rica, 2022

Potential Effects of Granting Registrable Property Rights over Land in Areas of the State's Natural Heritage
with Juan Robalino / UNDP and Universidad de Costa Rica, 2021

The Effect of Regulation on Fees for the Use of Cards on Consumer Prices
with Juan Robalino, Rudolf Lucke, Luis Oviedo and David Navarro / Universidad de Costa Rica, 2021

Methodological Proposal and Roadmap for Measuring Resources Allocated to Children in Costa Rica
with Juan Robalino and Luis Oviedo / UNICEF, Patronato Nacional de la Infancia and Universidad de Costa Rica, 2020

Economic Impact of the Plastic Tax
with Juan Robalino, Rudolf Lucke and Luis Oviedo / UNDP and Universidad de Costa Rica, 2019

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATION

Climate Change Perceptions and Adaptive Responses of Small-Scale Farmers in Two Guatemalan Landscapes
with Bárbara Viguera, Francisco Alpízar, Celia A. Harvey, M. Ruth Martínez-Rodríguez and Milagro Saborío-Rodríguez
Agronomía Mesoamericana, 30(2), 313–331, 2019

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Economic Analyst, Ecoanálisis Economic and Financial Consultants 2013–2014
Monitored macroeconomic developments; organised seminars on the economic outlook and policy

GRANTS, AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Economics Tutor Award (Highly Commended), The University of Manchester 2026
Heinz König Award, ZEW Leibniz Centre for European Economic Research 2025
Small Project Facility Grant (Principal Investigator; £13,930), International Growth Centre, LSE 2025
Royal Economic Society Scholars Fund, Royal Economic Society 2025
PhD Enrichment Scheme Award, Institute for Fiscal Studies 2024
Economics PhD Studentship, The University of Manchester 2021
Mentorship Research Support Grant (mentor: J. Robalino; US$10,600), Universidad de Costa Rica 2020
Chevening Scholarship (MSc studies), Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, UK 2017
Academic Excellence Scholarship (BSc studies), Universidad de Costa Rica 2010

SERVICE

Organiser, Economics PhD Seminar, The University of Manchester 2025–2026
TA Representative, Department of Economics, The University of Manchester 2024–2025
Residential Life Advisor, Directorate for Student Experience, The University of Manchester 2022–present

SKILLS

Programming Stata, R, Python, Matlab, ArcGIS
Languages Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (advanced)